ASSIGNMENT – 01

STORYBOARD

"The EV Price War: Can Tesla Compete with Chinese Electric Cars"

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INTRODUCTION AND RATIONALE

For this project, I have chosen the theme of analysing the increasing rivalry between Tesla and the Chinese electric vehicle companies, especially BYD, and to discuss the impact of this rivalry on the consumers, policy-making, and the market. I chose this topic since the most recent sales statistics and news across the world suggest that the market of electric vehicles (EV) has a new leader. Tesla, which was thought to be the leader in innovation in the industry, currently experiences the heavy pressure posed by the Chinese car manufacturers of cheaper alternatives. Of interest to the Canadian context, in particular, is this issue since tariffs, trade policy debates, and federal EV incentives affect accessibility and affordability to consumers. I did this because I wanted to investigate beyond merely the competitive environment but the human aspect of such market changes.

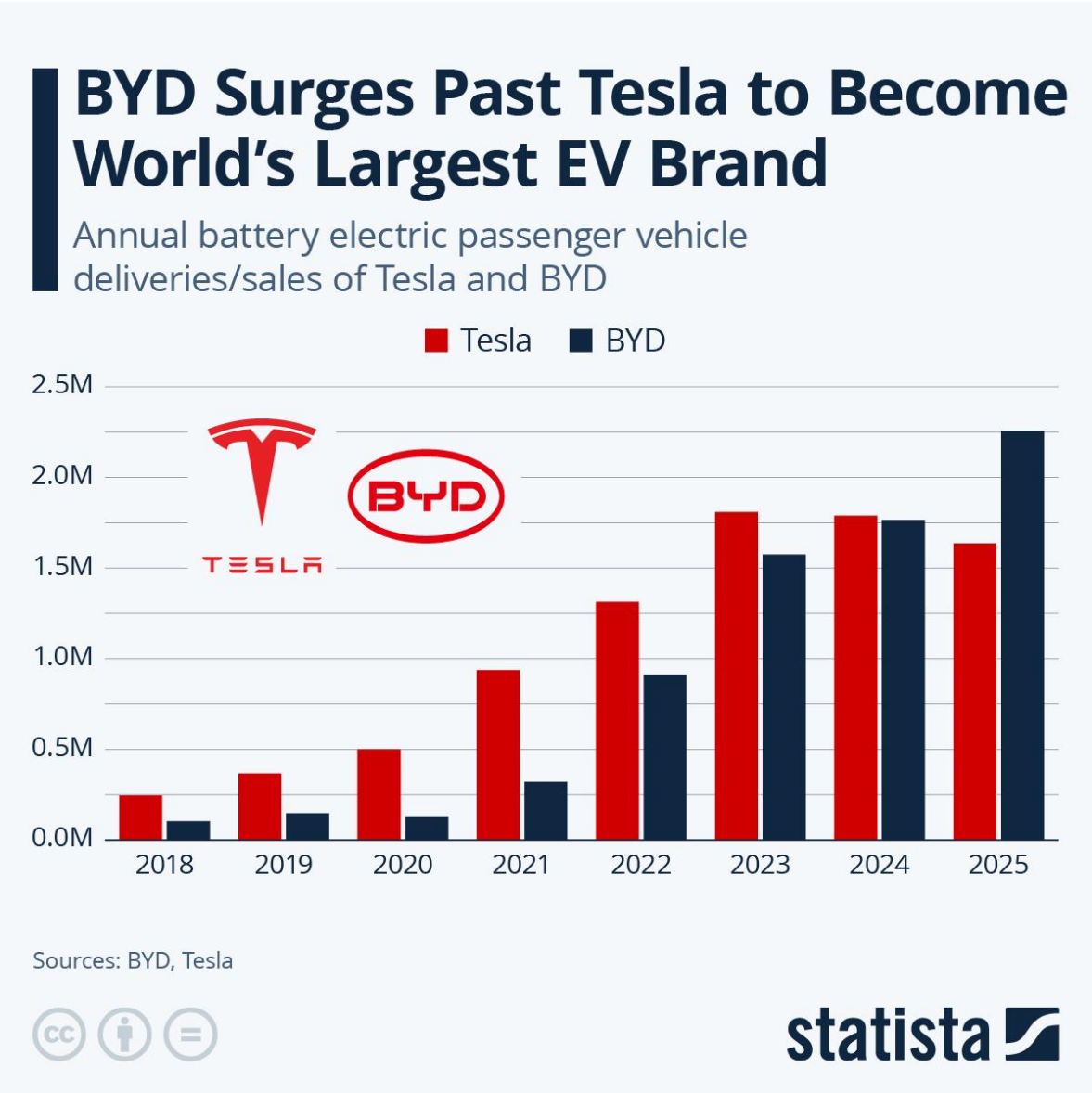
DESCRIPTION OF METHODS AND TECHNIQUES

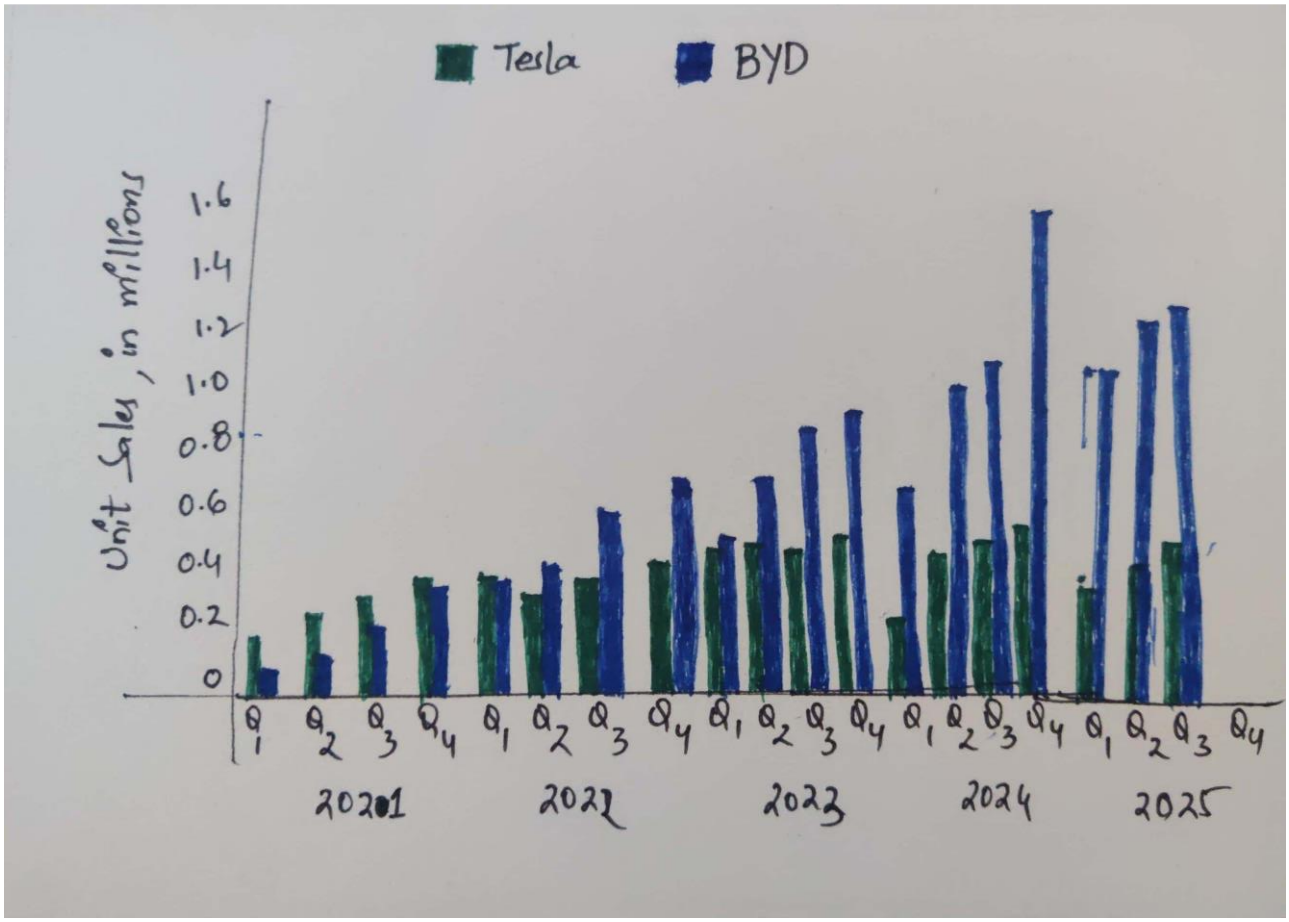
In order to carry out this analysis, I have checked recent news articles, car industry blogs, and governmental communications covering the sales performance of EVs, their pricing policy, and the policy development. I contrasted prices of models offered by Tesla with those of cheaper Chinese EVs and analysed how foreign trade and changing tariffs can affect the supply in Canada. Instead of providing the information as a market report, I assumed a narrative format based approach where the focus of the information is a hypothetical Canadian buyer. This methodological choice availed me the opportunity to convert quantitative data into a human story which is in line with the objective of the project of high-lighting the human in the narrative.

ITERATION 01- Market and Data Focus

In the first version, I primarily followed the comparative statistics like quarterly sales in which BYD has surpassed Tesla and graphs in which the difference between the prices of the Tesla and the Chinese EVs of lower costs is presented. This version gave a good presentation of trends in market share, pricing and

production scale but this version seemed more of a corporate or financial report than a human story. Although the data helped to understand how aggressively the Chinese manufacturers are competing on cost, it did not explicitly indicate why it is relevant to the people in deciding whether they can afford to join the EV transition.



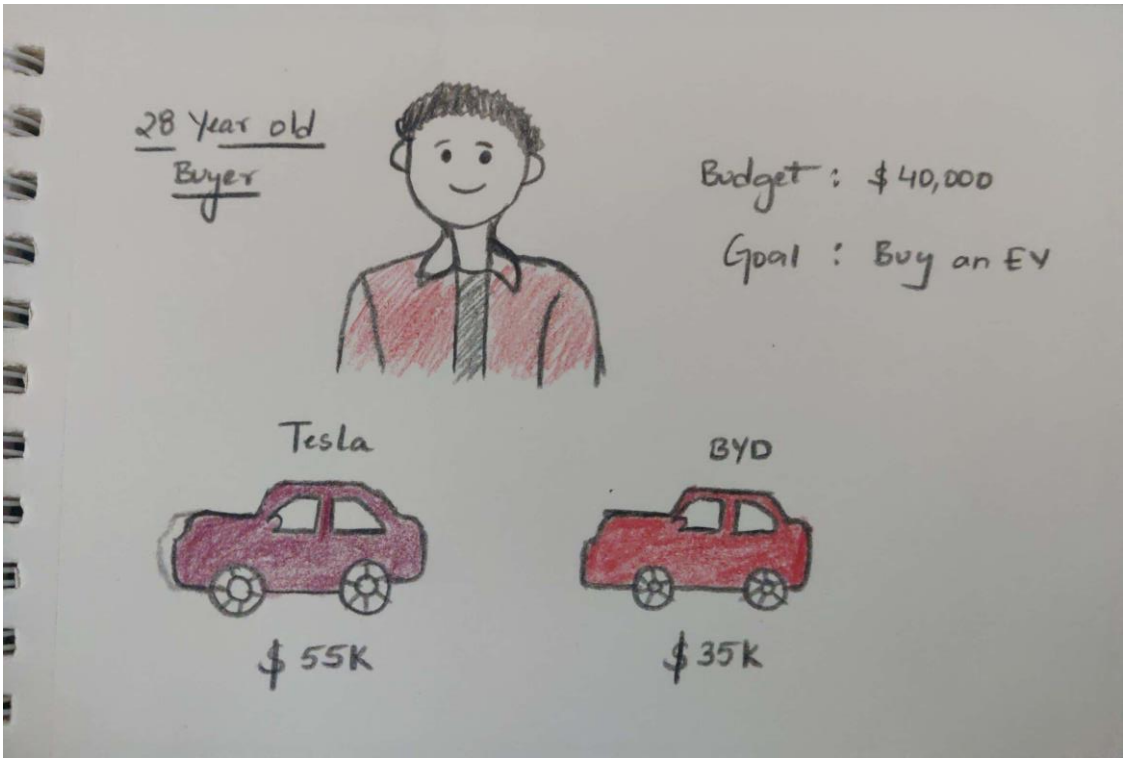

Tesla
BYD
Unit Sales, in millions
1.6
1.4
1.2
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0
Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4 Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4 Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4 Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4 Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025

ITERATION 02 - The Introduction of the Human Element.

In the second round, I added a buyer person, a 28 year old professional whose budget is about 40,000 and is planning to buy an electric car. This reversed the field of analysis where it was a company-company competition but shifting it to consumer making decisions. Once the cost of a Tesla model is above the means of the buyer and a Chinese EV is inside the range, the abstract notion of the price war turns into a very real problem. This anthropocentric perspective enhanced the lucidity and the relatability of the story. It also highlighted the practical financial concerns of young professionals and those who are first time owners of EVs.These five separate infographic style charts that I used for storyboard has different context.

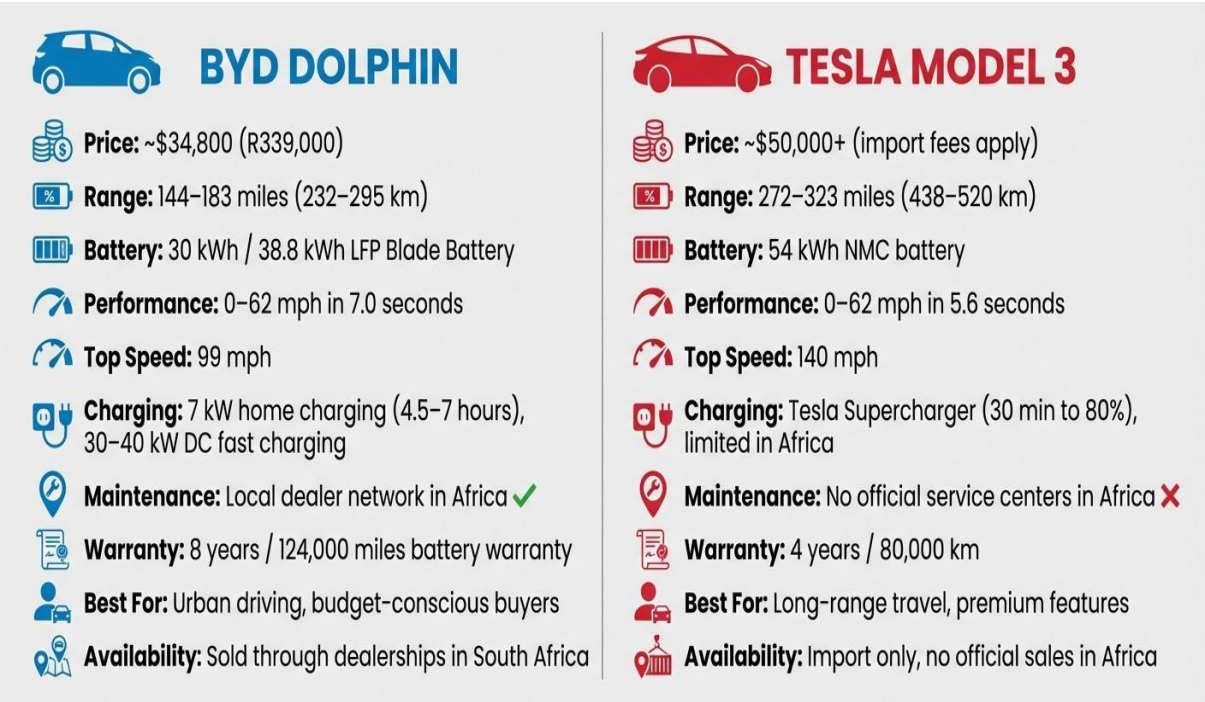
FIRST INFOGRAPH:

This image shows about a 28 years old buyer to buy EV car with in a budget 40,000 CAD in Canada.



SECOND INFOGRAPH:

This image shows about the price differences between BYD and tesla cars in African buyers.



THIRD INFOGRAPH:

The line graph shows that key states of tesla(model Y) and byd(atto 3).

Key stats comparison

	Tesla Model Y Rear-Wheel Drive	BYD Atto 3 Extended Range
Price (MSRP)	$68,900	$47,381
Battery (Useable)	60 kWh	60.4 kWh
Range (WLTP)	455 km	420 km
Efficiency (WLTP)	132 Wh/km	144 Wh/km
Acceleration (0-100 km/h)	6.9 s	7.3 s
Boot space	854 L	434 L
Charge Power (AC)	11.0 kW	7.0 kW
Fast charge Power (DC)	170 kW	80 kW

FOURTH INFOGRAPH:

This data depicts the size comparison of two EV vehicles

Size comparison

	Tesla Model Y Rear-Wheel Drive	BYD Atto 3 Extended Range
Dedicated EV platform	Yes	Yes
Platform	TESLA 3/Y	e-platform 3.0
Dimensions (LxWxH)	4751 x 1921 x 1624 mm	4455 x 1875 x 1615 mm
Wheelbase	2,890 mm	2,720 mm
Kerb weight	1,929 kg	1,690 kg
Boot space	854 L	434 L
Boot space max	1,900 L	1,338 L
Ground clearance	168 mm	175 mm
Towing (Unbraked)	750 kg	TBC kg
Towing (Braked)	1,600 kg	TBC kg

FIFTH INFOGRAPH:

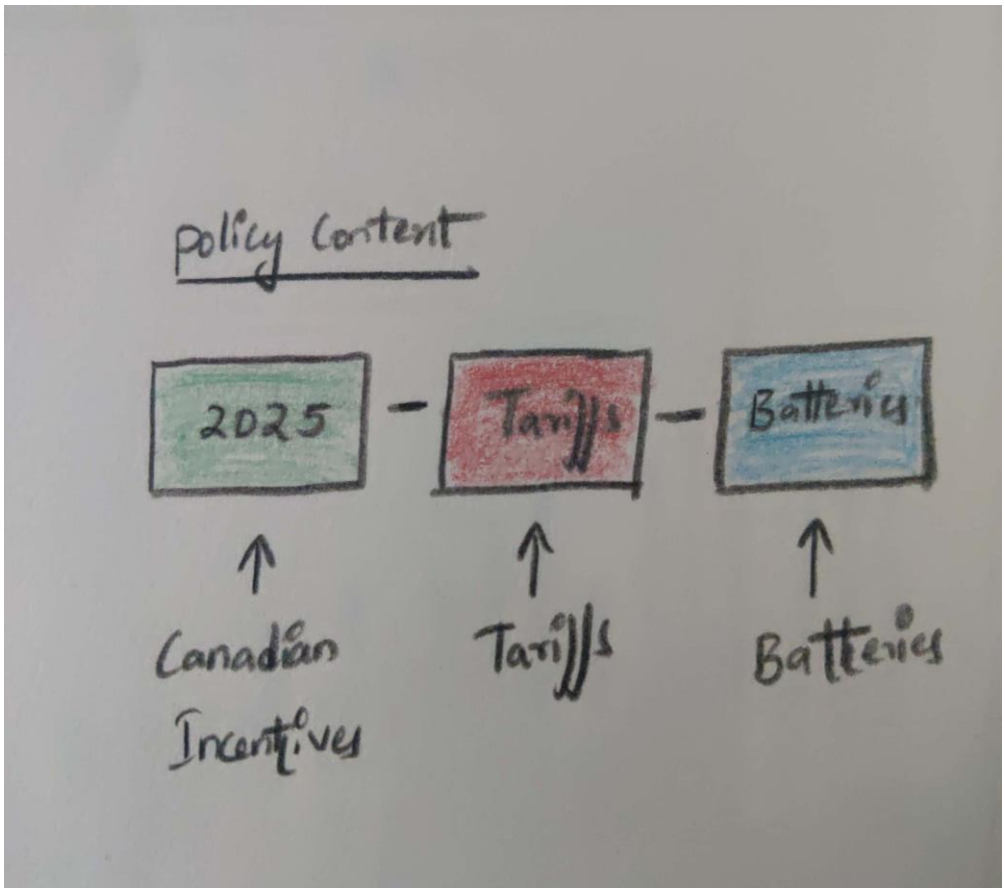
The driveway pricing list in Australian States.

Driveaway pricing
(post incentives)

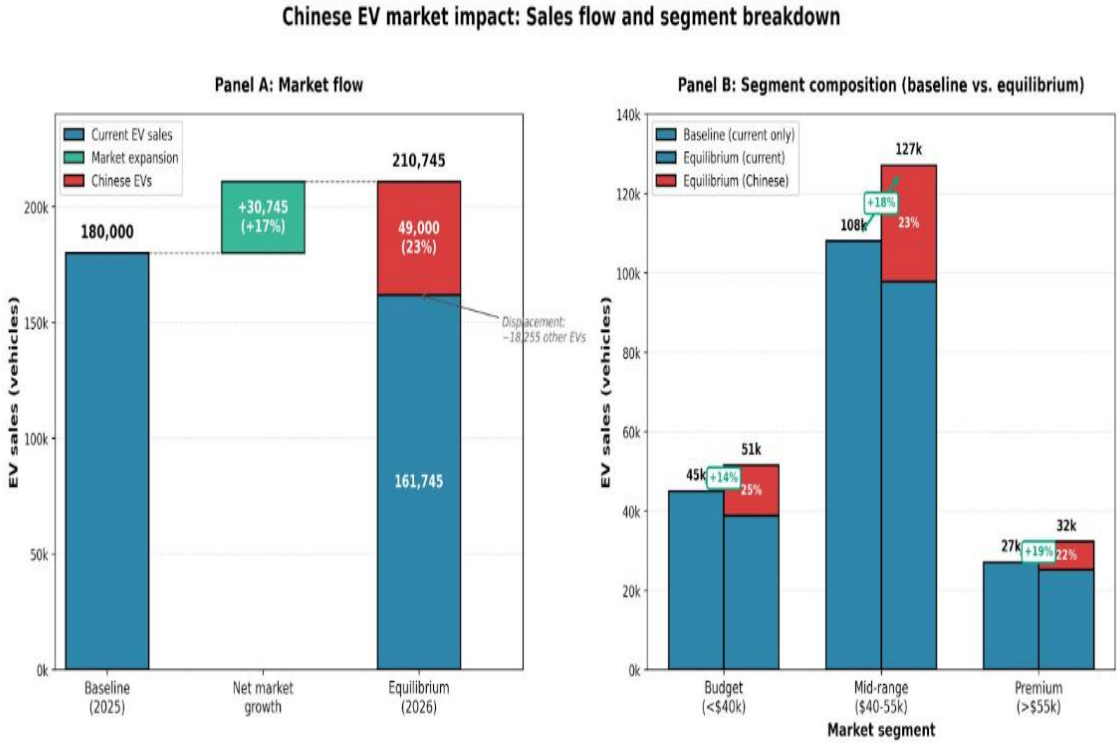
	Tesla Model Y Rear-Wheel Drive	BYD Atto 3 Extended Range
NSW	$71,757	$45,488
ACT	$71,088	$47,819
VIC	$74,247	$47,001
SA	$74,086	$46,886
TAS	$71,519	$48,250
WA	$76,204	$47,678
QLD	$72,742	$46,007
NT	$71,823	$47,934

ITERATION 03- Policy context and Canadian Impact

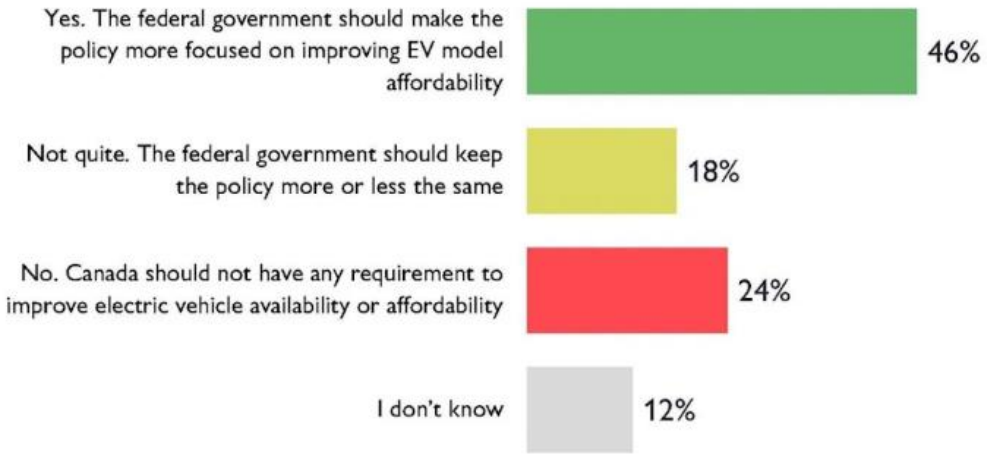
The third version involved the inclusion of bigger policy and economic variables to balance the individual point of view with the structural analysis. To show how government policy can influence consumer choice and market competition, Canadian tariff discourse and federal EV incentives were mentioned. This enabled me to relate the micro-level decision-making (the individual buyer) with macro-level forces (global trade, pricing strategy, and industrial competition). With the combination of these views, the project was transformed into a more in-depth and conscious story.



This chart would represent a hypothetical scenario showing how Chinese EV entry could impact the Canadian electric vehicle market.



This chat shows about the poll conducted by abacus data and clean energy data highlighted that 46% of Canadians supported revising the federal electric vehicles to make electric vehicles more affordable.



FOR THE AUDIENCE

This work is aimed at the university students and readers who may be interested in business analytics, global trade, and consumer economics. I also hope that the readers will understand that corporate competition is not restricted to market share and profitability, but it has a direct bearing of affordability, accessibility, and innovation. I also intend the readers to challenge the assumptions of brand supremacy and to reflect on the way the new entrants can upset the industry giants. Finally, I would like the audience to see that economic changes are not limited only to corporations but also to individuals in their daily financial decision making.

CONCLUDING THOUGHTS

To conclude, this storyboard shows that the price war between Tesla and Chinese companies, including BYD, is not just a business war. It reflects a wider change in the manufacturing industry, power of prices and accessible consumers. My focus on the individual buyer allowed me to emphasize on the human side of the statistical trends and corporate strategies. The future of the electric vehicle market will be determined not only by the level of technological progress and efficiency in production but also by the choices of consumers who will have to balance their financial possibilities, the availability of government subsidies, and their own priorities.